

## Castling in problems

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Perhaps the most unusual chess move in over-the-board play is castling. In practical play castling, as a rule, occurs in every game, but in chess problems it appears much less often. Of particular interest are problems with two castlings of one of the sides, which, of course, cannot happen in a game according to chess laws. In general, there are not so many problems with two castlings of white, black, or one white and one black. Alexandr Kuzovkov in a recent article in the Russian magazine '64' points out that in Turevsky database there are only 14 two-movers, 15 three-move, and three longer-movers involving castling. Most of them are miniatures or lightweight problems with very modest content. I give below a few examples quoted by him.

F.Kapustin

'Chess composition' 2006



Mate in two moves

1.Bd6? (2.Qxe7), 1...0-0-0! 2.Rb8, 1...0-0! - the try has castling as a thematic refutation. 1.Bf6? (2.Qxe7), 1...0-0-0 2.Qc6, 1...0-0 2.Rh8#. In the second try there are mates to both of black's castlings, but 1...Bb4! **Key 1.d6!** (2.Qxe7) 1...0-0-0 2.Qc4(changed mate!)1...0-0 2.Rh8, 1...Kf8 2.Qxf7,1...Kd8 2.Qxd7#.

In the solution, the checkmate is changed to a long castling for the third time.

The three-mover, compared to a two-mover, allows for much more varied ideas and meaningful play. Let's look at Kubbel's problem below with two white castlings.

L.Kubbel

'64' 1940



Mate in three moves

1.Rd1? Bd6! 1.Rf1? Bf6!

After **Key 1.e3!** Black is in zugzwang. 1...Bd6 2.0-0-0! B~ 3.Qxd7, 1...Bf6 2.0-0! B~ 3.Bxf7 1...Bd8 2.Rd1! B~ 3.Qxd7,1...Bf8 2.Rf1! B~ 3.Bxf7 the tries reappear as second move continuations.

Now a simple two-mover for solving

R. Heinen

"Deutsche Schachblatter", 1931



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Half-battery masterpieces':

1.Nc3? waiting 1...Kf3 2.Bd5;1..Kh3 2.Bf1;1...Kh5 2.Be2;1...Kxf5 2.Bd3 but 1...d5! Key 1.Bd5 waiting 1...Kf3 2.Nc3;1...Kh3 2.Nf2;1...Kh5 2.Nxf6;1...Kxf5 2.Nxd6. A remarkable star flight change in Meredith

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